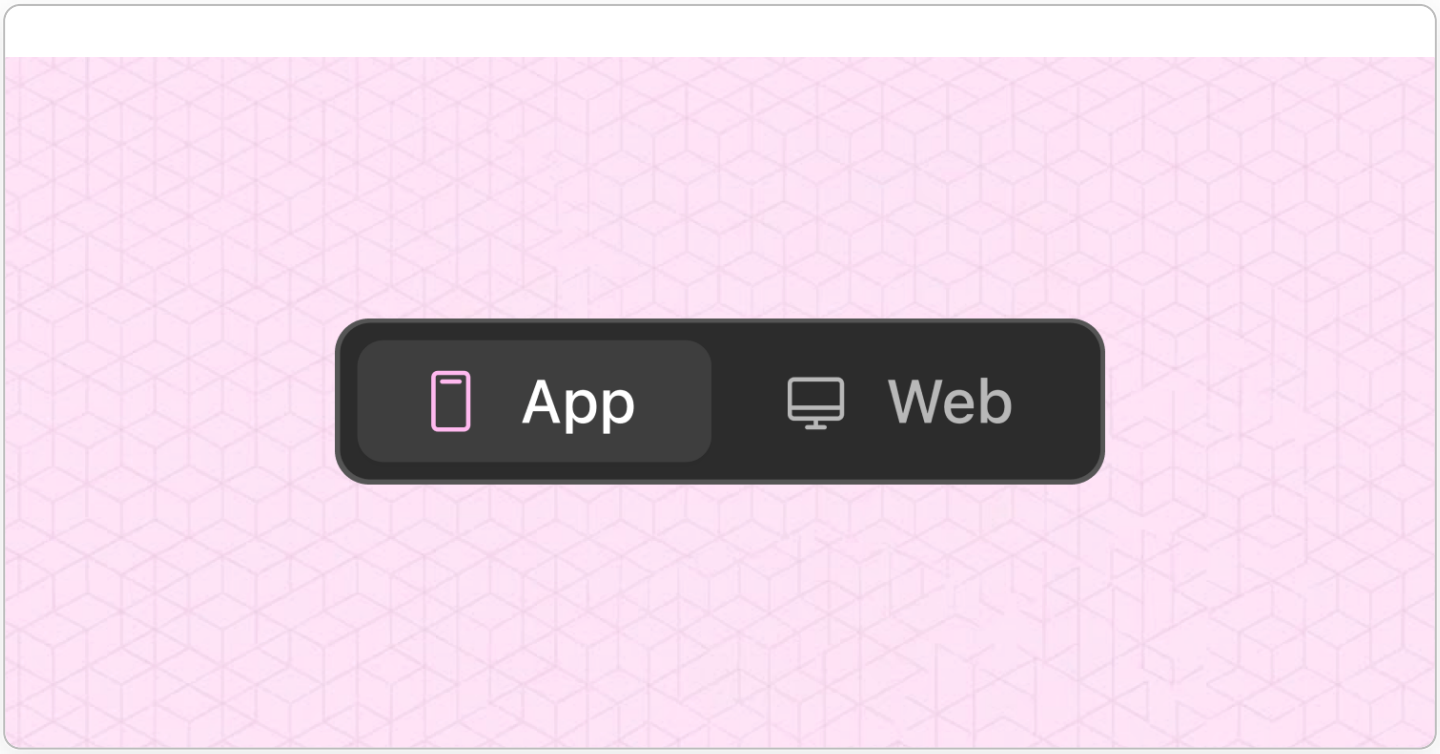
Stitch BETA

LEARN

Device Types

How to choose your canvas and translate designs between App and Web.



When you start a project, Stitch asks you to make a choice: **App** or **Web**.

This isn't just about screen size; it is about defining your **Primary Design Surface**. The device type dictates how Stitch interprets layout, navigation, and hierarchy.

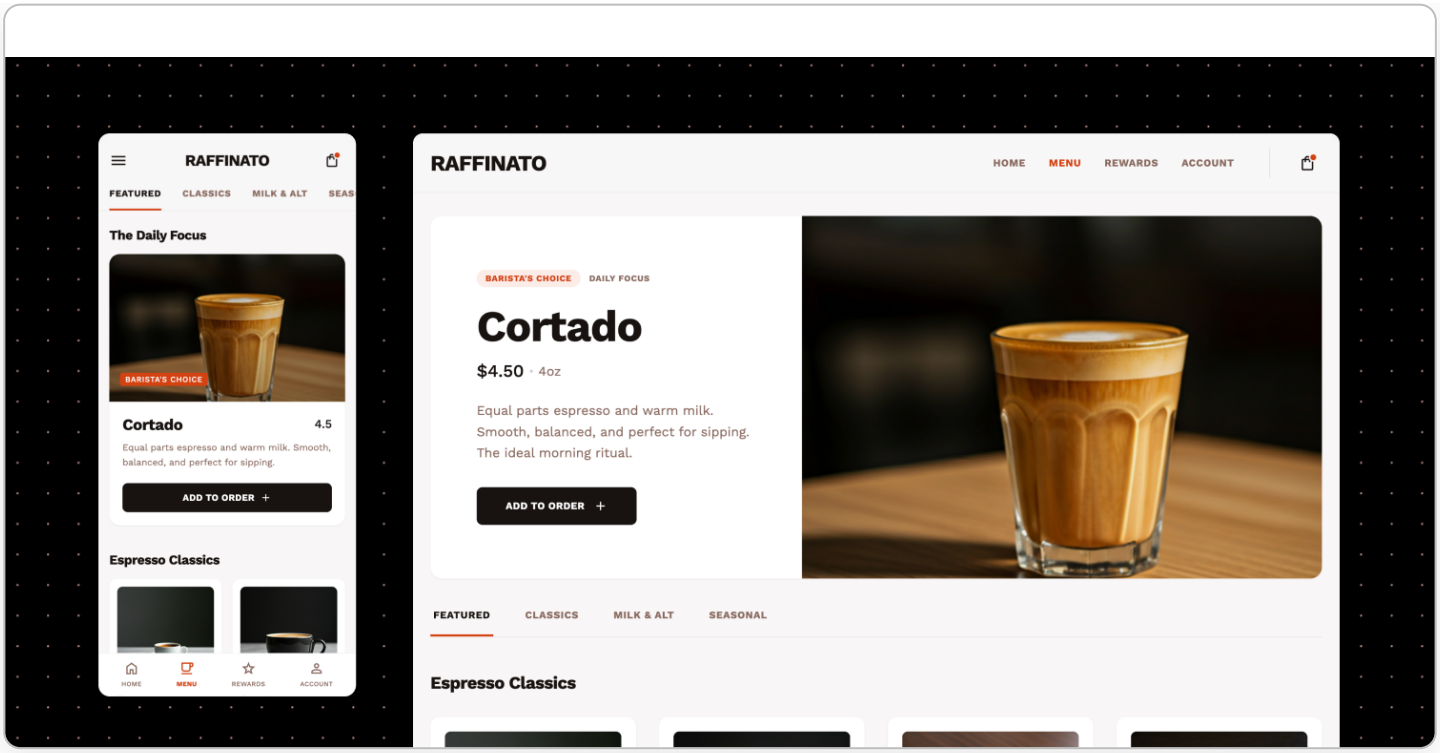
Layouts rely on context

- **App Mode:** Optimizes for vertical scrolling, bottom-aligned navigation (thumb zones), and stacked content.
- **Web Mode:** Optimizes for horizontal sprawl, top-aligned navigation, and multi-column grids.

A sceen designed in **App Mode** will look like a large app when viewed on a desktop. Conversely, a **Web Mode** design squeezed onto phone screen often loses critical details and UI components expected on native mobile apps.

Designing between modes

The best way to move from one platform to another is not to resize, but to **translate**.



If you have a mobile app design and want a web version, draft a prompt that describes what needs to change to optimize the design for that device type. First, use an existing design as a **Reference Image** for a new project or an update for a new screen. A new screen can be tricky in the way Stitch currently works but we'll detail some ways to help smooth that over below.

Phase 1: The App Design

Let's look at an example for this *Raffinato* app. *Raffinato means refined in Italian.* This project started in **App Mode** because the mobile ordering flow was most important.

PROMPT

IDEA	An ordering app for a local quality obsessed espresso focused coffee shop named Raffinato.
THEME	A light, high contrast theme with a modern and minimalistic feel.
CONTENT	Prefer a variable sized grid layout: 1 column on one row, followed by 2 columns on the next. Break up the grid into sections with labels categorizing the types of drinks in each section. Provide a mobile ordering layout for common espresso drinks with placeholder values for prices. Focus on the typographic balance for menu items placing the visual emphasis on the item name and less emphasis on details such as size in ounces, and price.
NAVIGATION	Provide navigation to easily switch screens between main grid, details, and the cart.

This generates a tight, vertical interface perfect for a phone.

Phase 2: Translating to Web

To move to Web, either create a **New Project** set to **Web Mode** or provide an update prompt in the existing project, and use a screen's downloaded image as a reference.

Your goal now is to tell Stitch how to utilize the larger screen real estate. Focus on core UI/UX aspects that need to change, such as the **Navigation**, the **Hero Section**, and the **Grid Density**.

Here is how the prompt handles the device type translation:

PROMPT

NAVIGATION	Consolidate the bottom tab bar and top menu into a single, horizontal navigation bar at the top of the screen with links for Home, Menu, Rewards, and Account.
HERO	Transform 'The Daily Focus' card into a split-layout hero section. Place the Cortado text and button on the left, and expand the image to cover the right side.
GRID LAYOUT	Update the product lists from a 2-column mobile layout to a 4-column desktop grid. Maintain the light cream card background and minimalist vibe.

By explicitly telling Stitch to move the navigation to the top and split the hero content, the prompt focuses on retaining the *feel* of the brand and optimizing the design for the utility of the device type.

Switching Device Types in the same project

When you create a Stitch project with a specific device type it will continue to generate screens of that device type's size. You can give Stitch a prompt to convert to another device type within the same project, but it requires manual finessing.

If you generate a Web prompt inside an App project, Stitch will generate the web content inside an app frame.

1. **Generate** the design.
2. Use **Preview > Device Type** to switch the view to the intended target (e.g., Desktop).
3. **Resize** the frame manually if elements feel cut off.

Pro Tip: The Hidden Content

When switching from App to Web within a project, try increasing the vertical height of the design frame significantly. Stitch often generates the “rest” of the website logic, but hides it because the original App frame was too short. Dragging the frame handle down can reveal the rest of your layout.